

Therapy Approaches

Core Vocabulary

When your speech and language therapist creates a therapy plan, there are different approaches that they can choose. There is no single intervention approach that works for every child and sometimes this may need to be changed. Based on current research and evidence based practice, your speech and language therapist will aim to select the right intervention to meet the needs of the child.

What is the core vocabulary approach?

We work on frequently used words and aim for consistency

Core Vocabulary

The core vocabulary approach is used for children who have disordered and inconsistent speech. Usually these children will be very difficult to understand.

The aim of core vocabulary is to get the child to produce words consistently, these may still not be accurate, but at least words will be produced in the same way each time they are said.

To achieve this, your therapist will create a word list that is functional and meaningful to the child. The words might include family names, favourite toys, food, pets, special interests or places and are words that are frequently used in their talking.

What happens in therapy?

- Before intervention, the therapist creates a list of around 50 words that are functional and meaningful to the child and picture cards are created.
- Between 5-10 of these words are selected to use in one therapy session
- The therapist will support the child to produce each of these words by using visual and verbal cues.
- The child may still make speech errors, but words will be produced consistently each time.
- Multiple repetitions are encouraged through fun games to help the child achieve consistency.
- When words are produced consistently on three occasions these are then substituted for other words on the list.
- Therapy continues until all words are consistent.

EXAMPLE

Johnny's speech is disordered and he produces words inconsistently each time e.g. 'car' may be produced as either 'tar' 'gar' or 'ar' The therapist spoke to parents and teachers to create a meaningful word list to use in therapy.

SAMPLE CORE VOCABULARY

CAR	MUMMY
DADDY	TOILET
ZACH	AUNTY SUE
DIGGER	SCHOOL

